

8.1 File Indexing and Search

As you keep using your PC, you create files, download some off the Internet, copy some from your office machine, and so on - and they tend to bloat your system. Unless you categorise them properly, searching for a particular file can be difficult to say the least. Moreover, with the growing use of the computer for digital entertainment, files from devices such as digital cameras, handycams, DVDs, MP3 players, and more are finding their way to the hard drive, adding to the agony of remembering where exactly a particular file is stored.

It would be a good thing to have an application that could locate any file at the click of a button - and that's exactly what file-searching applications do.

Here, we review three such applications - Google Desktop Search, Yahoo Search and Copernic Desktop Search.

8.1.1 Google Desktop 2 (GD2)

Google Desktop was Google's first attempt at bringing its powerful online searching capabilities to the desktop. In its second iteration, this nifty utility has metamorphosed into an application that retrieves valuable information not only from your computer but also from the Web.

The installer is 1.3 MB, and can be downloaded from Google's Web site (desktop.google.com). Recommended system resources are 500 MB of hard drive space, a minimum of 256 MB of memory, and a 400 MHz processor. Once installed, the application prompts for setting up of preferences, which can later be altered from the menu.

With GD2, you can search for e-mails from Gmail, Outlook, Outlook Express, Netscape, Thunderbird and Mozilla Mail. Common files types such as PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, PDF, MP3, and video files can be searched for. You can even search via meta tag data such as artist name, song title, etc. Messenger chat